CTH TOOLS INVENTORY SYSTEM

Complete User Manual

Version 2.0.0

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1. SYSTEM OVERVIEW

CTH Tools Inventory System is a complete Point of Sale (POS) and Inventory Management solution for hardware stores, tool shops, and industrial suppliers.

Key Features:

- Secure Login with Admin/Cashier roles
- Live Stock Monitoring with Low Stock Alerts
- Barcode Scanning POS
- 15% South African VAT Auto-Calculation
- Professional PDF Invoices
- Automatic Backups
- Sales Reports
- User Management
- Audit Logging

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2. SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Component	Minimum Requirement
Operating System	Windows 7, 8, 10, 11 / macOS / Linux
Java	Java Runtime Environment (JRE) 11 or later
RAM	2GB

Component	Minimum Requirement
Disk Space	100MB (plus database growth)
Display	1024 x 768 resolution
Optional	USB Barcode Scanner, Receipt Printer

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3. INSTALLATION

Step 1: Install Java

1. Go to: https://www.java.com/download/
2. Click "Download Java"
3. Run the installer
4. Follow the on-screen instructions

Step 2: Run the Application

1. Extract the "CTH_Inventory_System" folder to your computer
2. Double-click run.bat (Windows) or run.sh (Mac/Linux)
3. OR double-click CTH_Inventory_System.jar

Step 3: License Activation

1. On first run, the License Activation screen appears
2. Enter License Key: CTH-DEMO-2024
3. Click **Activate**

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4. LOGIN

Admin Login (Full Access)

Field	Value
Username	admin
Password	admin123

Admin Can:

- ✅ Add/Edit/Deactivate Products
- ✅ View Profit Reports
- ✅ Manage Users (Add/Edit/Reset Passwords)
- ✅ View Audit Logs
- ✅ Restore Backups

Cashier Login (Sales Only)

Field	Value
Username	cashier
Password	cashier123

Cashier Can:

- ✅ Process Sales
- ✅ Scan Barcodes
- ✅ View Stock Levels
- ❌ Cannot Edit Products
- ❌ Cannot View Reports

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5. ADMIN DASHBOARD

Viewing Products

- All products are displayed in a table
- **Red rows** = Low stock (5 or less items)
- Search by name or barcode

Adding a Product

1. Click **"Add Product"** button
2. Enter:
    - Barcode (unique)
    - Product Name
    - Category (Welding, PPE, Tools, etc.)
    - Cost Price
    - Selling Price
    - Initial Quantity
    - Low Stock Threshold
    - Supplier (optional)
3. Click **"Save"**

Editing a Product

1. Right-click the product row
2. Select **"Edit Product"**
3. Update the details
4. Click **"Save"**

Deactivating a Product

1. Right-click the product row
2. Select **"Deactivate Product"**
3. Confirm

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6. POINT OF SALE (POS)

Starting a Sale

1. Login as Cashier (cashier / cashier123)
2. The POS screen opens

Adding Items

1. Click the **Barcode** field
2. **Scan** a barcode OR **type** the product code
3. Press **Enter** or click **"Add to Cart"**

Changing Quantity

1. Click the item row in the cart
2. Click **"Set Quantity"**
3. Enter the new quantity
4. Click **OK**

Completing a Sale

1. Click **"Complete Sale"** (OR press F9)
2. Enter customer name (optional) → Click OK
3. Select payment method (Cash/Card/EFT) → Click OK
4. The sale is processed!
5. A PDF invoice is automatically generated

Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Action
F9	Complete Sale
F2	Clear Cart
Enter	Add item to cart

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7. INVOICES

Where Invoices Are Saved

CTH_Tools_System/invoices/

Invoice Format

- File name: CTH-YYYYMMDD-XXXX.pdf
- Example: CTH-20260722-5103.pdf

What's On The Invoice

- Company name, address, phone
- Invoice number and date
- Customer name
- Itemized product list
- Subtotal, VAT (15%), Total
- Payment method
- Banking details for EFT

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8. REPORTS (Admin Only)

1. Go to the **Reports** tab
2. Select **Date Range** (From → To)
3. Click **"Generate Report"**
4. View sales summary
5. Click **"Export to PDF"** to save

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9. USER MANAGEMENT (Admin Only)

Adding a User

1. Go to **User Management** tab

2. Click **"Add User"**
3. Enter:
    - Username
    - Full Name
    - Role (Admin/Cashier)
4. Click **"Create"**
5. The system generates a temporary password

Resetting a Password

1. Select the user
2. Click **"Reset Password"**
3. The system generates a new password

Activating/Deactivating a User

1. Select the user
2. Click **"Toggle Status"**

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10. BACKUPS (Automatic!)

What Gets Backed Up

- All sales data
- All products
- All users
- Audit logs

When Backups Happen

1. **Every time you close the program**
2. **Daily at 2:00 AM** (if the program is running)

Where Backups Are Saved

CTH_Tools_System/backups/

Backup Files

- Format: backup_YYYY-MM-DD_HH-MM-SS.sql
- The system keeps the last 7 backups

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11. SETTINGS (Admin Only)

1. Go to the **Settings** tab
2. Update:
    - Business Name
    - Address
    - Phone
    - Bank Details (Bank Name, Account Number, Branch Code)
    - Low Stock Threshold
    - VAT Rate (default 15%)
3. Click **"Save Settings"**

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12. TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem: "Java is not installed"

Solution: Download from java.com

Problem: "License Key Invalid"

Solution: Use CTH-DEMO-2024

Problem: "Database is locked"

Solution: Close and reopen the program

Problem: "Cannot find invoice PDF"

Solution: Check CTH_Tools_System/invoices/

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13. CONTACT SUPPORT

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